
Faiza Gondal
VISUAL ARTIST

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https://www.instagram.com/mini.arcui?stkn=YzNvOXAzc3g5d2ht

BIOGRAPHY

Faiza Gondal is a Lahore-based multidisciplinary visual artist whose practice is deeply rooted in the traditional discipline of Mughal Miniature Painting. Her work explores the relationship between historical visual traditions and contemporary personal experience, treating tradition as a living language rather than a fixed inheritance.

She holds a degree in Arts Journalism from the University of the Punjab, Lahore, which has shaped her sensitivity toward narrative, observation, and layered meaning. Her artistic training includes Traditional Fresco Painting, Fresco-secco and Islamic geometric/ floral illumination Art (Naqashi/Tezhib), and specialized study in Traditional Miniature Painting at the National College of Arts (NCA), Lahore.

Working primarily on handmade Wasli paper, Gondal also explores watercolor paper and canvas, employing traditionally prepared gouache, organic pigments, mineral powders, gum Arabic, gold leaf, and tea or coffee washes. Her contemporary practice emerges from personal reflection, emotional depth, memory, and her observation of the world around her.

Further enhancing her studio practicing she has learned Kashkari (Tezhib Art) in Ceramic Terracotta and Stone tiles, oil painting on canvases.

She has exhibited nationally and internationally, participated in artist residencies, conducted workshops. One of her miniature artworks has been acquired for PNCA (Pakistan National Council of Arts, Islamabad) Gallery's permanent collection, and she was honored with Certificate of Honour in recognition of her Artistic contribution.

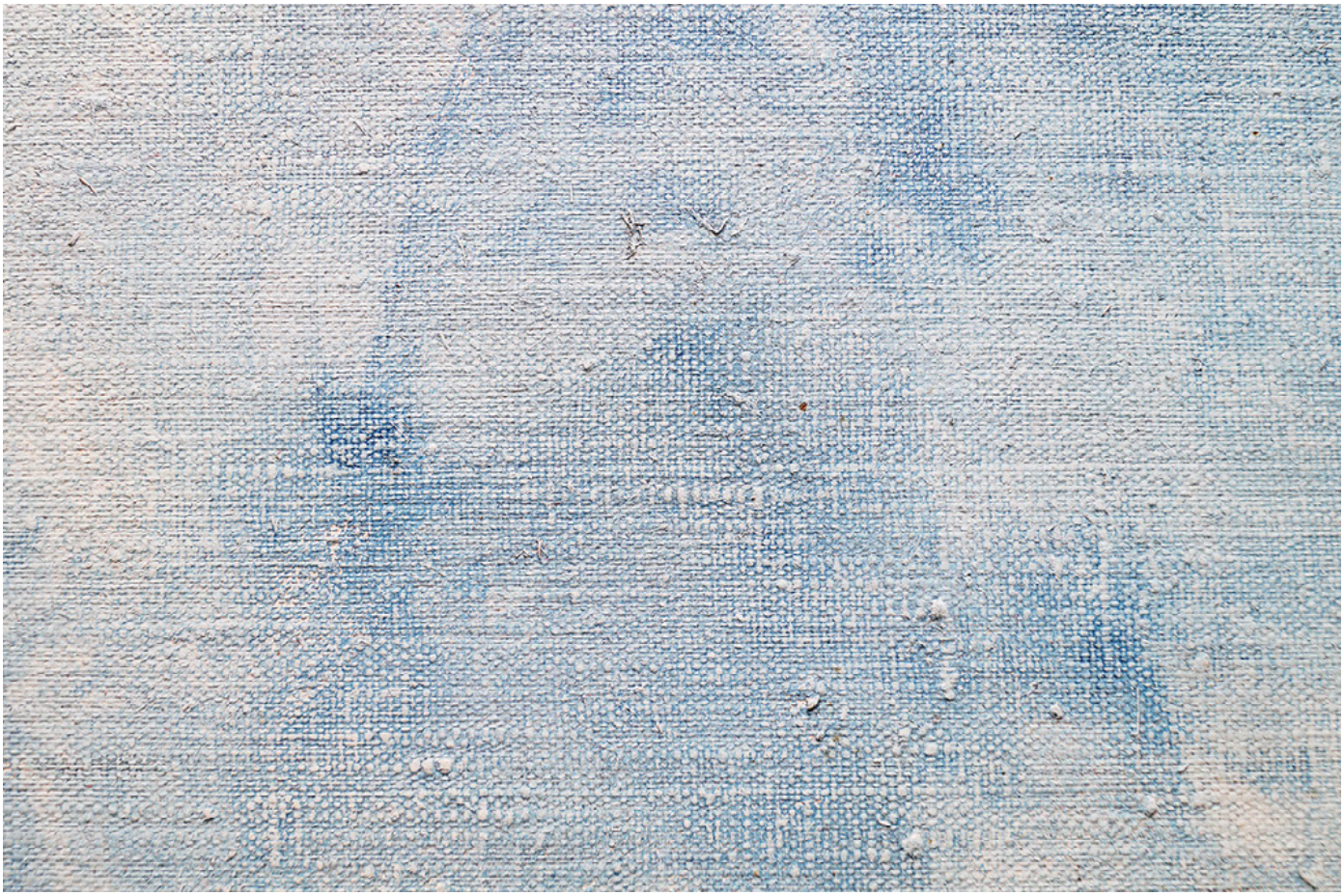
ARTIST STATEMENT

While my works are deeply rooted in historical practice, my approach is conceptually contemporary. I explore how traditionally can speak to present-day experiences and emotional state. By merging classical methods with modern themes, my practice is an evolving and diverse expression of the way I experience and perceive the world. Each work carries traces of life and emotions that moves through me. My observation and inner responses become starting points from which each work takes shape. I do not confine myself to single medium and visual language, instead, I allow the subject and emotions to determine its forms.

I create contemporary paintings that explore the traditional Mughal miniature techniques, using hand-made gouache that is made of organic mineral white powder and organic gum-Arabic. My paintings are created on hand-made traditional paper “WASLI” and at times, water-color sheets and canvases. Through layered washes of tea and coffee and use of gold leaf, I build surfaces that are both delicate and luminous and enhance depth.

Rather than offering fixed narratives, my paintings create open and intimate spaces for reflection, between memory and presence, the earthly and the spiritual, personal and the collective. They invite viewers to slow down and engage with subtle emotional shifts.

Through my studio practice, I aim to preserve the discipline and intimacy of Traditional art and Mughal/Persian Miniature painting while reimagining its relevance within a contemporary, global context.





Title: What The Silence Keep

Medium: Gouache on dyed watercolor textured sheet

Size: 10.16x15.24 cm (4x6inches)

Year: 2026

Artist Statement:

The painting is asking **"What happens next, but what is already changing while we wait"**

There is always something waiting on the other side of the wall.

A girl looks through a narrow opening, curious yet uncertain. Beyond her, another presence appears only in fragments—a pair of feet, a small caterpillar, a butterfly. Above them, a crow rests quietly on the edge, watching.

I am drawn to moments that exist between knowing and not knowing, between what is revealed and what remains hidden. My figures appear partially, as if they belong to stories that began long before the viewer arrived.

The wall becomes a threshold—a place between two worlds, two states of being, perhaps two versions of oneself. The caterpillar and butterfly suggest a transformation that is both fragile and inevitable, while the crow becomes a silent witness to what is unfolding.

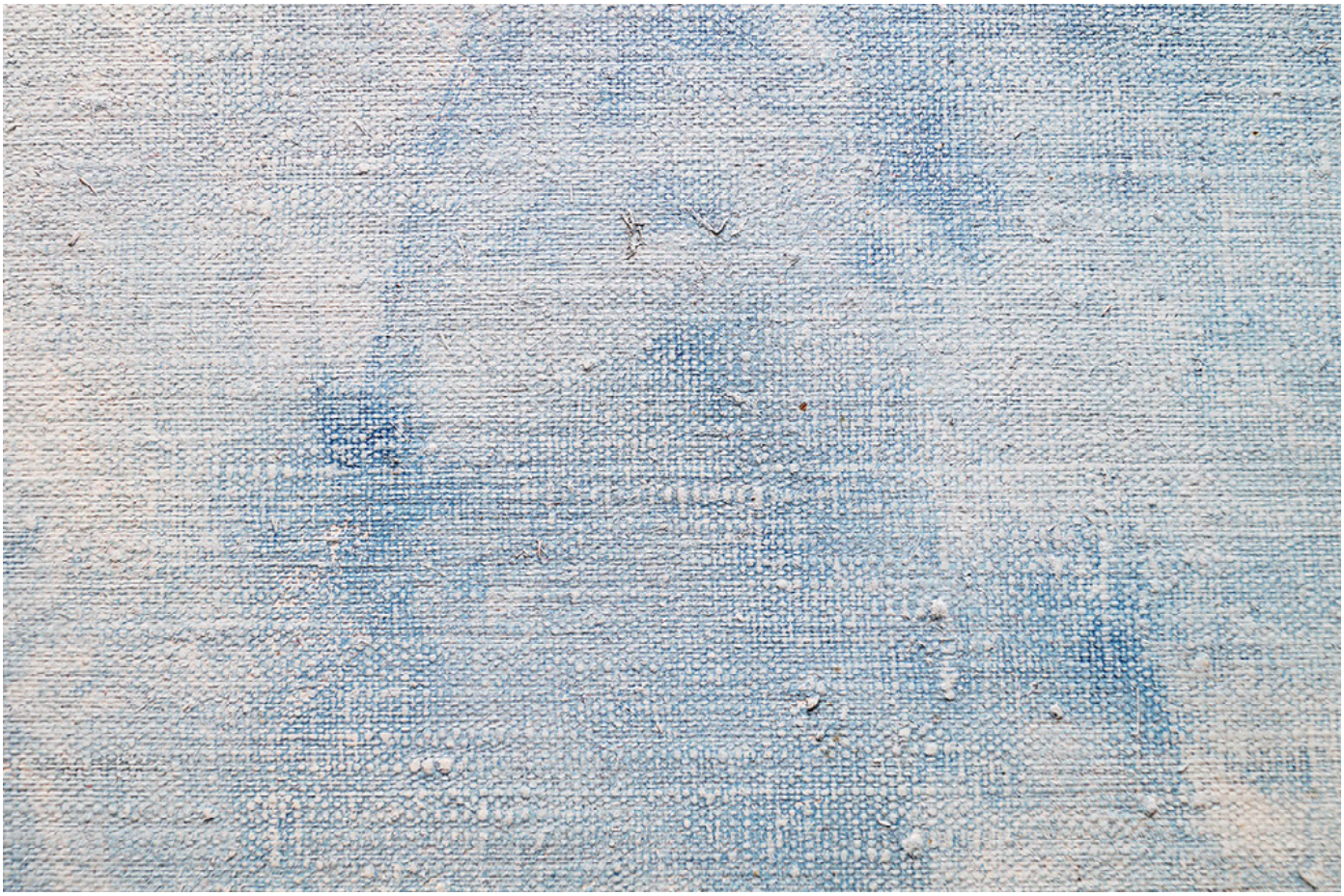
I do not want to explain the story completely. I want to leave a space for the viewer to enter it—to wonder who is watching whom, what lies beyond the wall, and what might be changing quietly beneath the surface.

Perhaps the painting is not about what we see, but about everything we sense is there.

CORRESPONDENCE WITH

Artist Statement:

I created a series of handmade postcards and posted them to the gallery through the Traditional post office—revisiting a time when postcards carried our messages, stories, and emotions. This exhibition brought back the warmth and innocence of childhood memories, when a simple postcard could hold so much meaning. In this series, I explore Mughal miniature gardens and heritage as visual souvenirs of a rich cultural past. I paint portrait of princes within carefully detailed garden settings, drawing inspiration from the elegance, architecture, nature, and symbolism of the Mughal era. Through these imagined scenes, I reflect on memory, history, and the way cultural heritage is preserved through art of postcard.





Title: The Soul of Letters Come Alive

Medium: Gouache on textured watercolor sheet dyed in coffee wash, handmade color

Size: 7x5 inches

Year: 2026



Title: The Soul of Letters Come Alive



Where Stories Breathe, what was Once Written

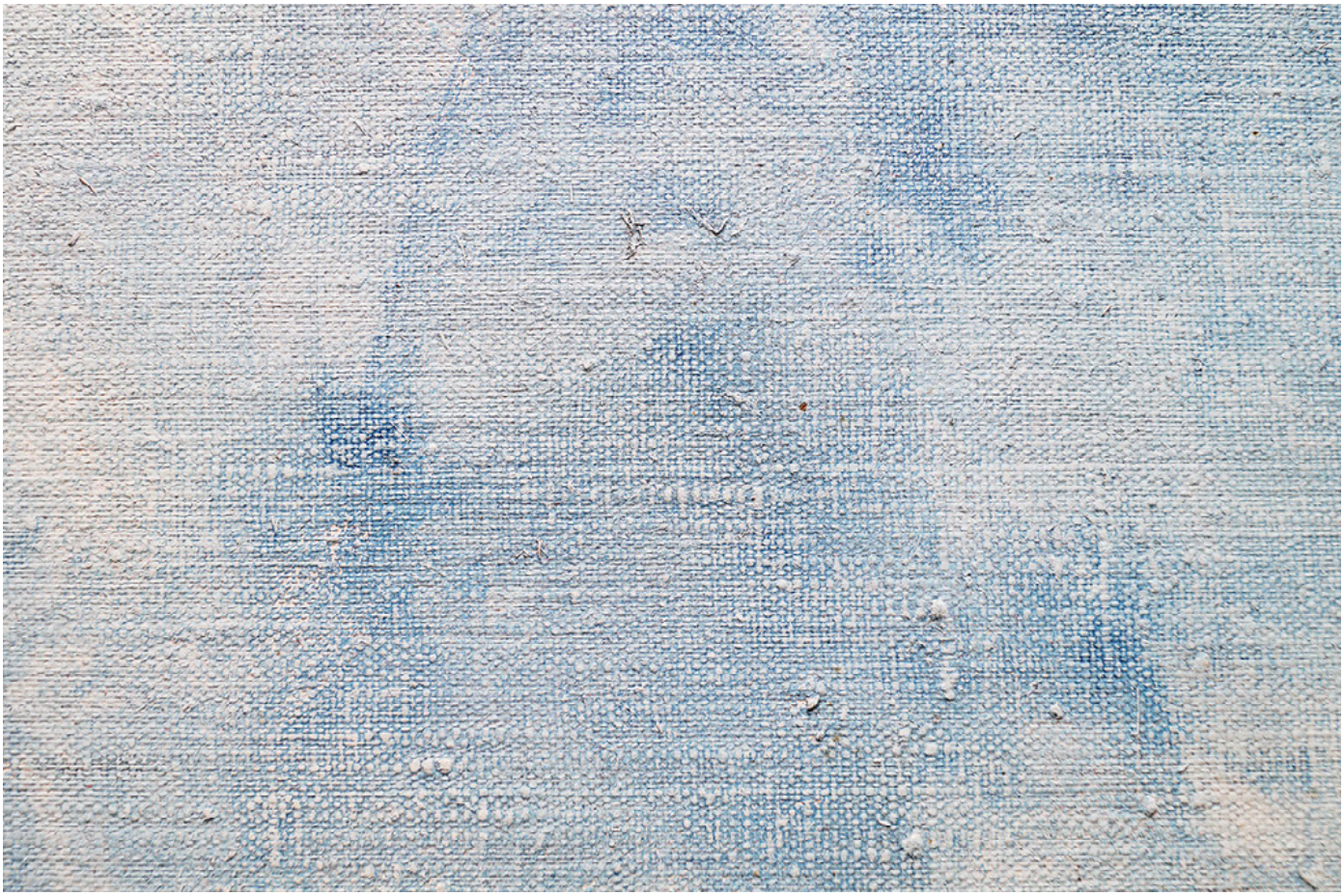
This series was created in 2025, in the hushed corners of the National Library. wandering through the antique book section I was enveloped by the scent of time-deep sense of nostalgia and whispered stories.





Title: Echoes Forgotten Tales and feathers

Medium: Gouache (hand-made color with mineral powder and Gum-Arabic) on textured high gram watercolor thick sheet (as wasli) prepped with Tea/Coffee/Gouache mixed washes.
Size: 24x19 inches
Year: 2025
Theme: This work explored themes of memory and the lingering echoes of old ages, emotions. Painted on the echoes of old ages, she urges a sense of nostalgia rooted in remembered moments, fragments of histories, and emotions that refuse to fade. The past emerges not as a fixed narrative, but as traces that quietly seep into the present.





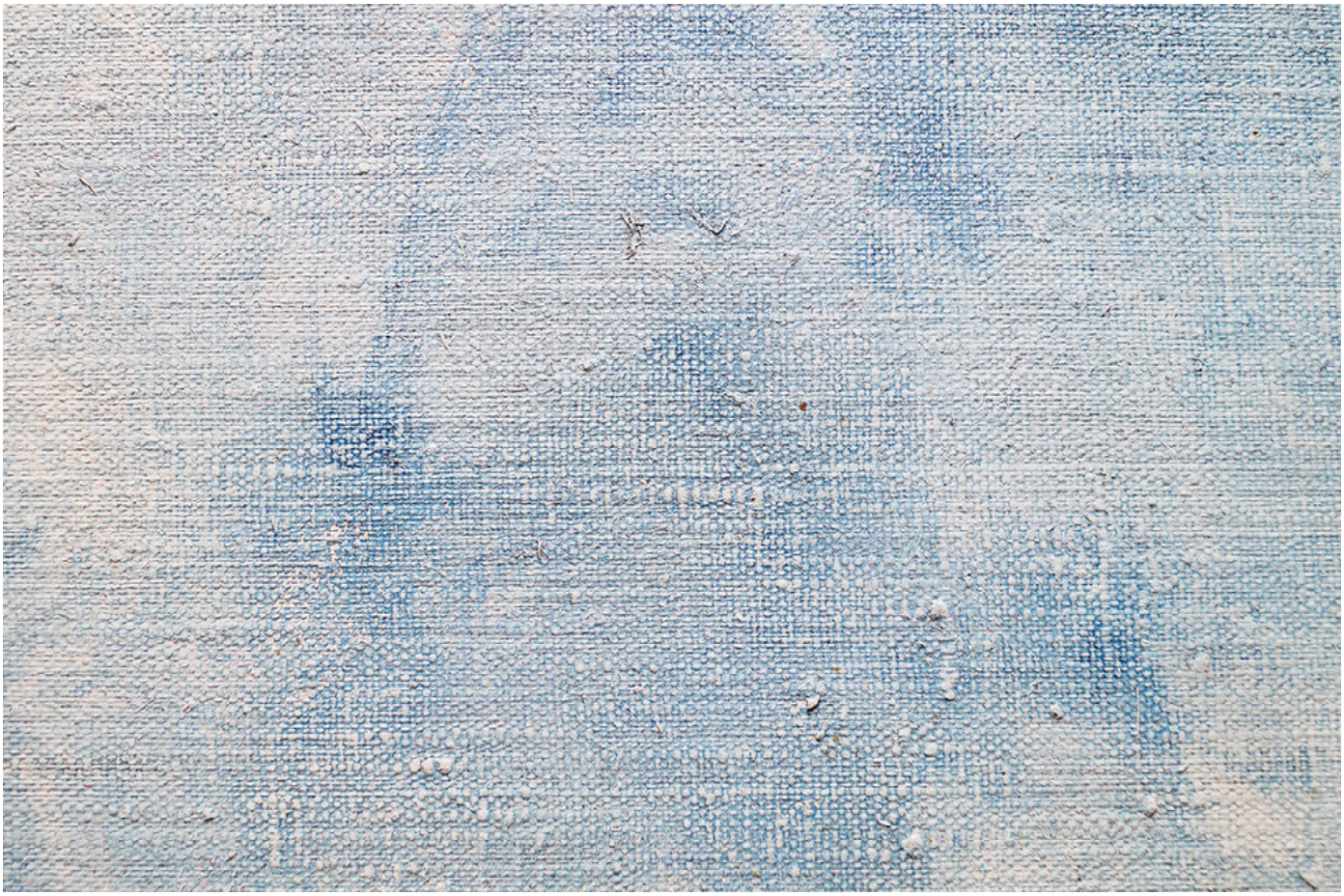
Title: Awakening Of Soul

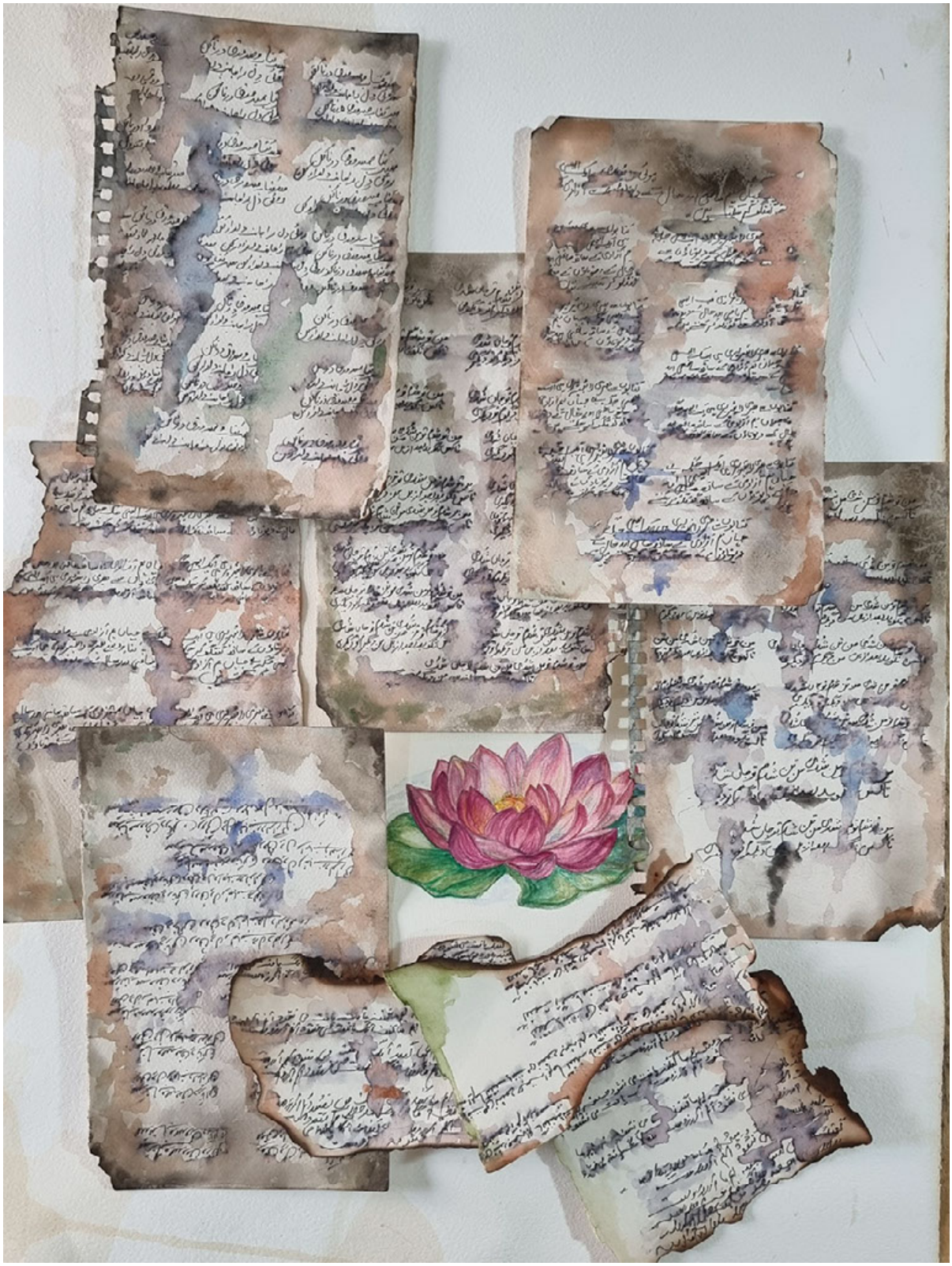
Medium: Gouache (handmade organic color) on watercolor high gram sheet (as wsli) prepped with tea/coffee/gouache mix washes

Size: 24x19 inches

Year: 2025

Theme: In this work, the imagery of old books, lotus flowers,and weathered pages and vintage aesthetics serve as powerful symbols to explore the delicate balance between the metaphysical and the physical realms. The use of books with written texts evokes the tangible power of language as both a communicator of thought and a vessel for deeper, often ineffable truths.The work becomes a meditation on how the physical world, in all its fragility, can still serve as a gateway to the eternal and the divine, inviting the viewer to reflect on the profound connections.





Title: self-purification

Size : 22×16"inches

Medium: Gouache (handmade organic color) on Watercolor sheet, (sheet burn with candlelight, gouache washes, text written with brush)

Year:2025

The work becomes a meditation on how the physical world, in all its fragility, can still serve as a gateway to the eternal and the divine, inviting the viewer to reflect on the profound connections between the seen and the unseen, the temporal and the eternal. In this work, the imagery of lotus flowers,and weathered pages and vintage aesthetics serve as powerful symbols to explore the delicate balance between the metaphysical and the physical realms.





Title: SOUL QUEST

Size: 28×22"inches

Medium: Gouache(miniature technique), tea wash, on Watercolor sheet

Year: 2025

This work embraces a contemporary visual language, exploring themes of memory and the lingering echoes of old ages, emotions. Painted on the echoes of old ages, she urges a sense of nostalgia rooted in remembered moments, fragments of histories, and emotions that refuse to fade. The past emerges not as a fixed narrative, but as traces that quietly seep into the present

In sequence: volume- I- II- III

Title of Series: KETTAB GHAR MAKAM-E-ISHQ (A Sanctuary of Love)

Medium: Gouache (hand-made traditional Mughal technique, using mineral white powder and organic gum-Arabic) on watercolor sheet, Gouache/tea washes

SIZE:

Volume- 1-Size: 14x11 inches

Volume- II-Size: 11x8 inches

Volume- III-Size:11x8 inches

Year: 2025


فائزه گوزدل



Title: KETTAB GHAR MAKAM-E-ISHQ(A Sanctuary of Love)

Volium-1-

Description: wandering through the antique book section I was enveloped by the scent of time-deep sense of nostalgia and whispered stories. Books drift beyond objects, becoming echoes of untold stories
and half-remembered lives. Their faded pages breathe memory, carrying the lingering fragrance of ink, ash, and time. The quill is no longer a tool but a presence-the trace of a voice that once spoken and continues to murmur. Burnt and worn pages hold the essence of age and survival, suggesting that although fragile, these narratives continue within us.


فائزہ گوندل



Theme title:” The Lamp That Still Remembers”

Volume-II

Title of Series: KETTAB GHAR MAKAM-E-ISHQ (A Sanctuary of Love)

Description: The painting centers on kerosene-lamp stand symbolic as a vessel of memory-weathered, patient and enduring. Its flame is not merely light, but a quiet warmth of love for memories and stories that continues to live within. The paper beneath it bears burnt edges, marked by closeness to that flame, suggesting devotion that comes at a coast. The lamp does not deny its warmth, yet it never offers its wings.

What remains is quiet illumination, carrying whispered stories of what once was-of nights spent waiting, of words half-written, of love that survives only as glow


فائزہ گوندل



Theme title: In Longing for His Wings, I Was Left Wingless”

Volume- III-

Title of Series: KETTAB GHAR MAKAM-E-ISHQ (A Sanctuary of Love)

Description: This painting traces the passage of months through worn text and scorched edges. Here faded words, charred at edges, stand as symbols of light-light of memories, forgotten stories and nostalgia and the moths themselves unfold his life in the love of light and paper carries scars of flame. The burnt edges mark a closeness to desire that leaves no escape, only remembrance-silent, incomplete, and suspended within loss.

Theme: **Thread of Life: Exploring connection and interwoven Narratives”**

Artist Statement:

The inspiration for my work comes from the handwoven Khaddi cloth ”Khess” made by my grandmother. These textiles, rich in cultural heritage history and love, featured intricate geometric patterns-an art form rooted in traditional illumination. This deeply personal connection became my central theme of work. Each cloth my grandmother created was unique, becoming vibrant colors with the symmetrical beauty of Islamic geometry. She lovingly crafted them for her granddaughters, embedding within each piece a legacy of Culture, tradition, and affection. To me this is more than just textile-itis, a visual expression of generational love and heritage. Inspired by this vision and deep connection with the design I grew up with, making it a fitting and meaningful
extension of my story. Through my work, I aim to honor the beauty of this tradition, blending personal memory with broader cultural narrative.





Title: Thread Of Connection

Medium: Oil paints on an upcycled linen fabric and cotton threads,
(upcycle fabric was a theme of exhibition, cloth provided by curator and organizers, prepared to cloth as canvas for oil paints, and drapery exhibited like tapestry in exhibition, Novatel Sharjah, UAE)
Size: 120cmx80cm
Year: 2025

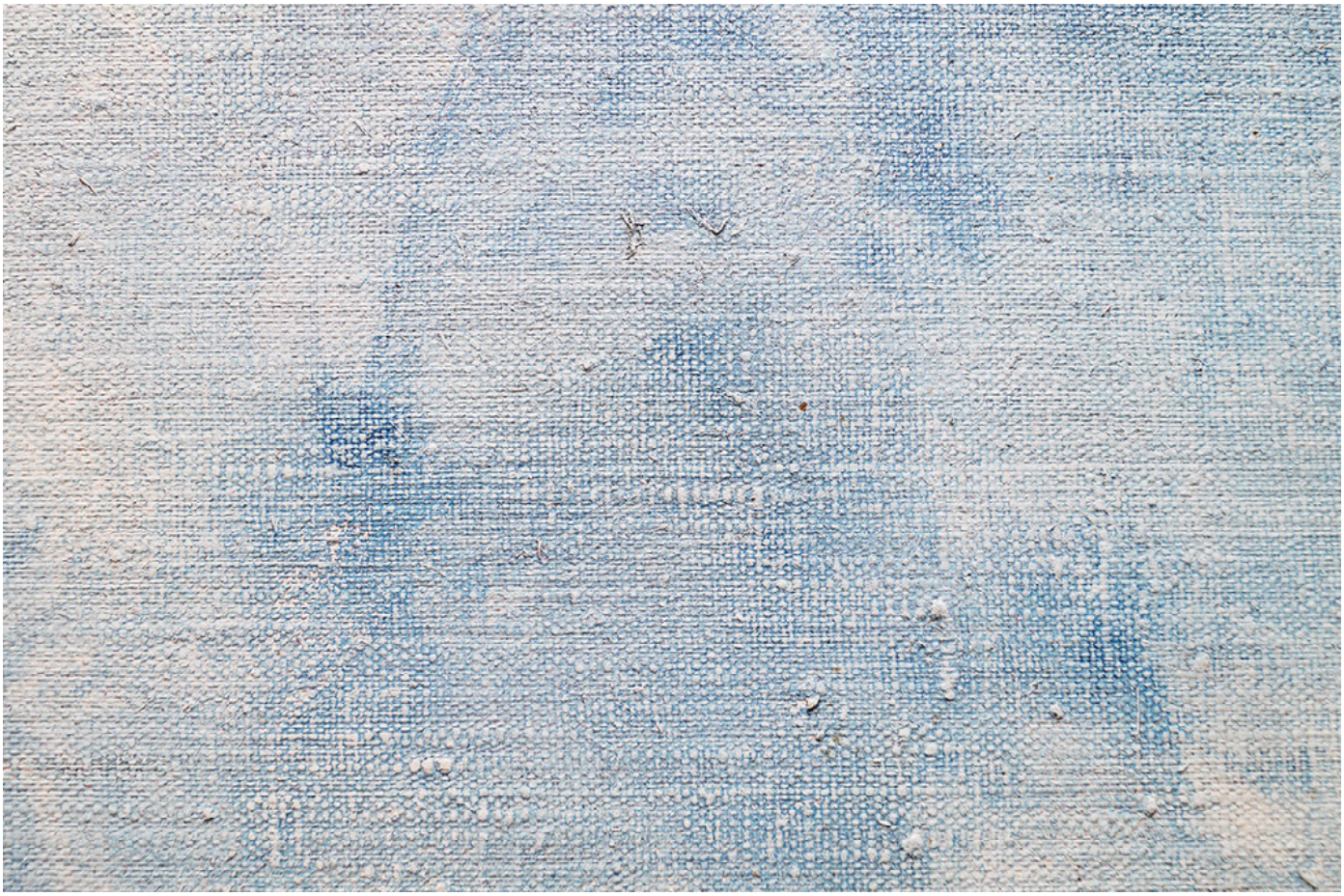
Theme: Divine Serenity (the series of paintings)

Artist Statement:

The body of work was created during 2024 in quite beauty of nature of Chatter, Islamabad, Pakistan, while I sat in moment of deep silence and solitude amidst the mountains, waterfall, trees and flowers, a Bee appeared and hovered around flower that very gentle whisper of nature or moment awakened an intuitive connection and became symbol of invisible dialogue.

Divine Serenity the series is built around the Bee as a symbol of feminine spirit-the quiet force responsible for sustaining and installing life upon Earth. As a pollinator, this act reflects the feminine spirit itself. In the hum of her wings lives an ancient truth: Life endures through connection, cooperation and love. The bee reminds us that feminine spirit is not fragile-it is foundational, regenerative and eternally life-giving.

Between nature and the feminine, portraying the earth as reflection of hidden faces of femininity. Through its cycles of growth, transformation, and resilience, nature mirrors the Strength, wisdom, mystery and creative power of the feminine spirit.





Title: Bloom Of Resilience

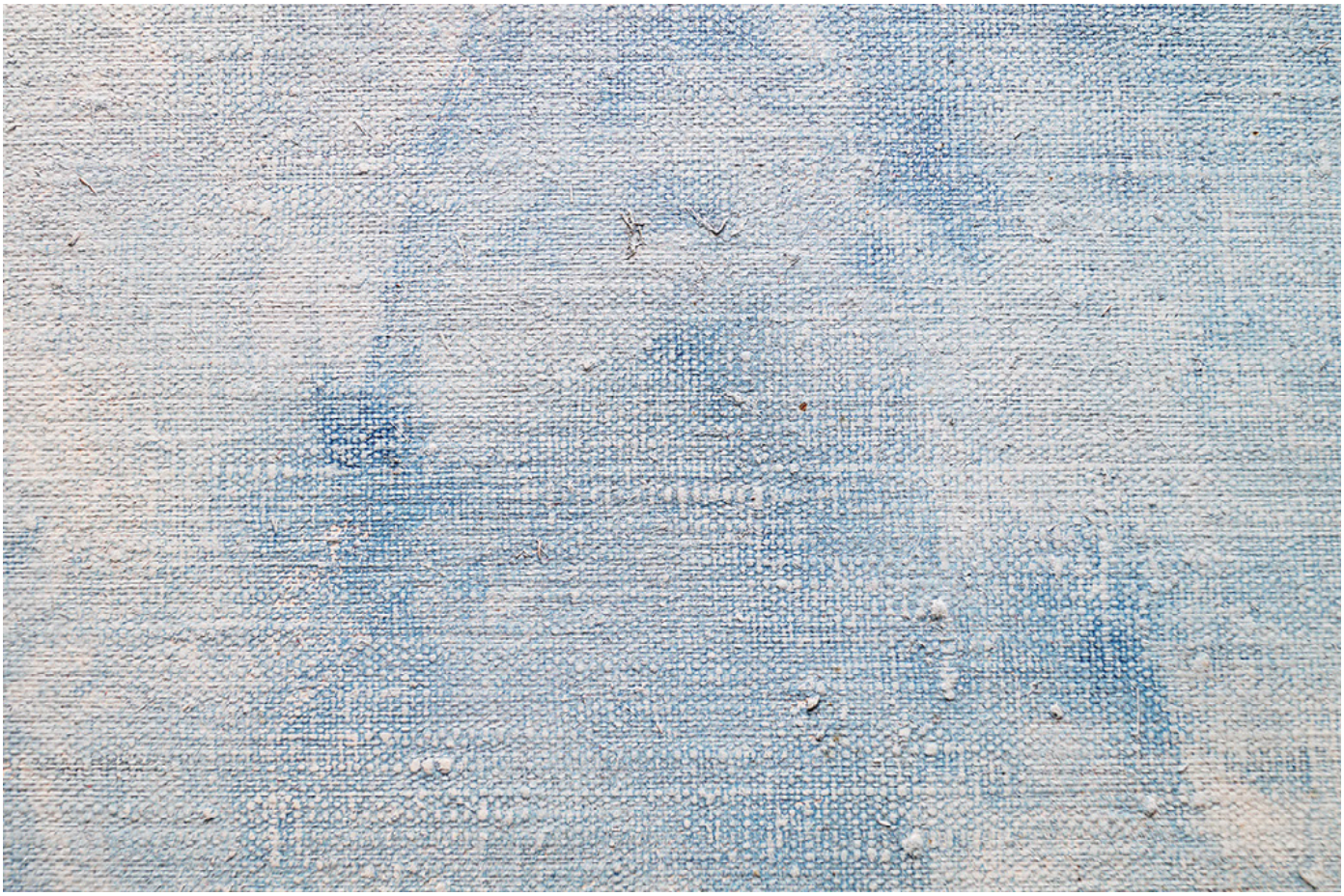
Bees as pollinators: Feminine infinity in the birth of new earth.

Medium: Gouache on Wasli, organic gold leafing

(Handmade paper, Handmade color)

Size: 14x11 inches

Year: 2024





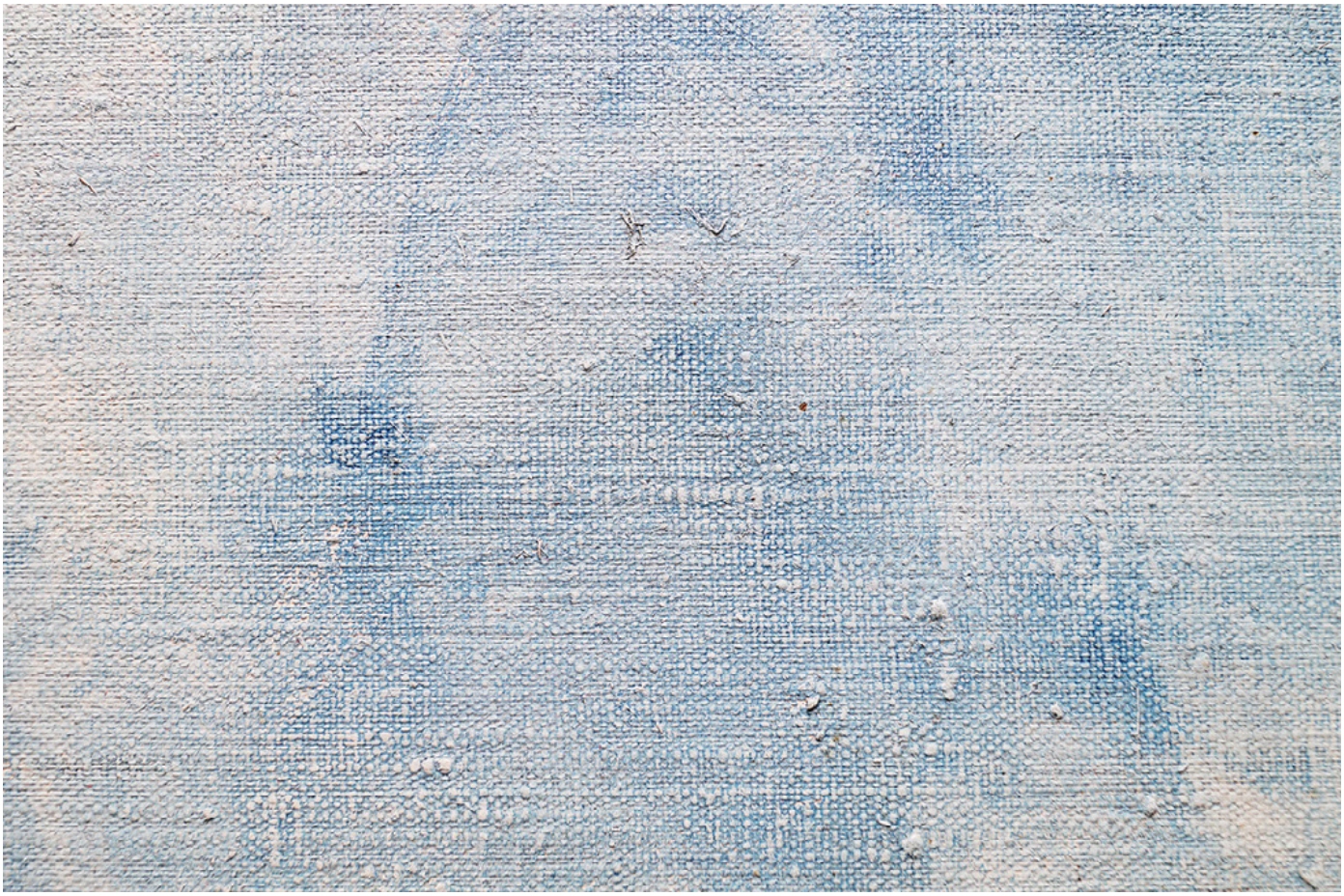
Title: **Fragile Sanctuary (in private colloction)**

Bees as pollinators: Feminine infinity in the birth of new earth.

Medium: Gouache on Wasli, organic gold leafing (Handmade paper, Handmade color)

Size: 14x11 inches

Year: 2024





Title: Symbiotic Awakening (in private collection)

Has been selected by Pakistan National Council of Arts (PNCA) Islamabad, as a part of Permanent Collection of Gallery and reworded by certificate of honor.

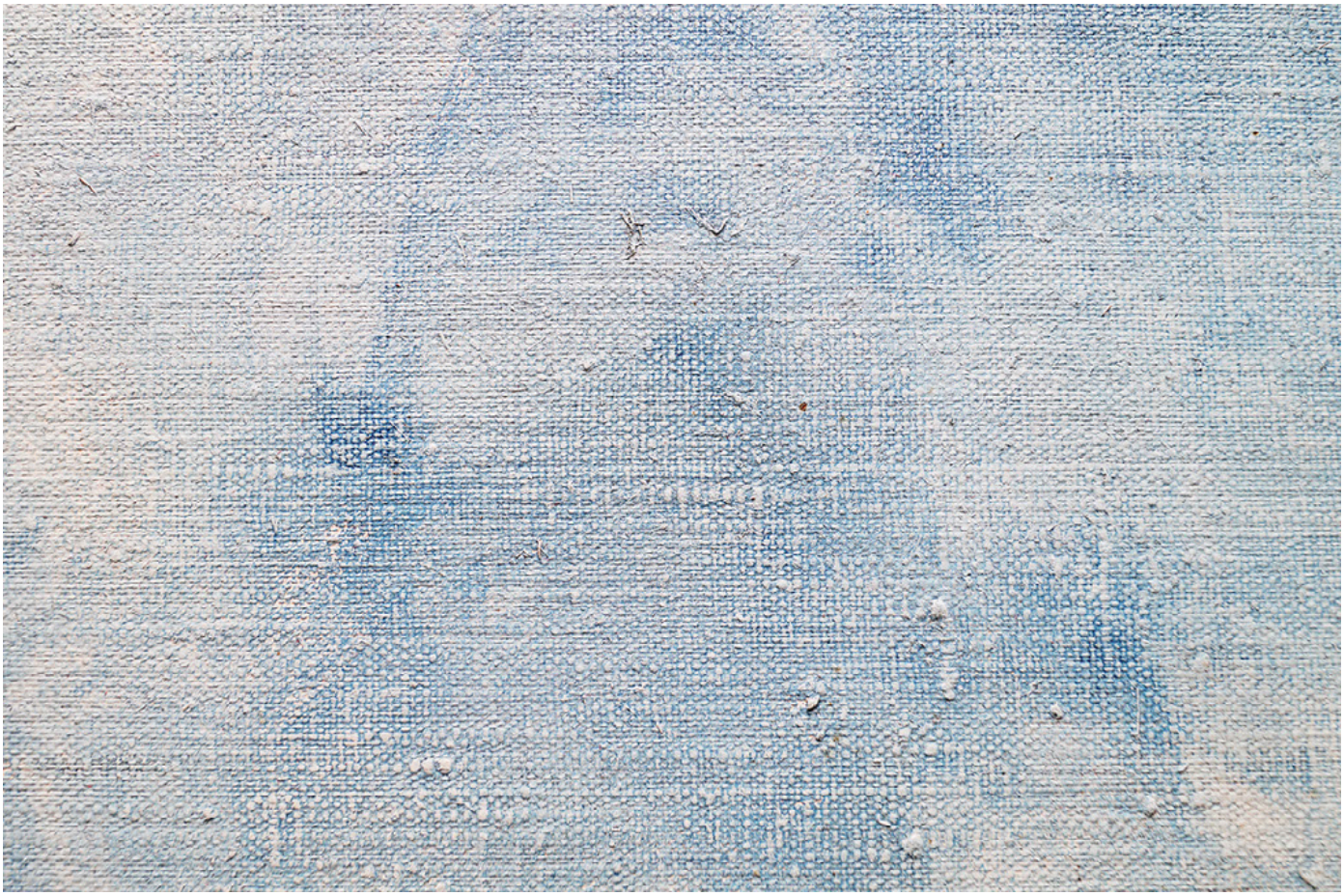
Bees as pollinators: Feminine infinity in the birth of new EARTH)

Medium: Gouache on wasli

(hand-made paper and hand-made gouache color)

Size: 14x11inches

Year: 2024





Title: The Pollinator's Plight (in private collection)

Bees as pollinators: Feminine infinity in the birth of new EARTH)

Medium: Gouache on wasli

(hand-made paper and hand-made gouache color)

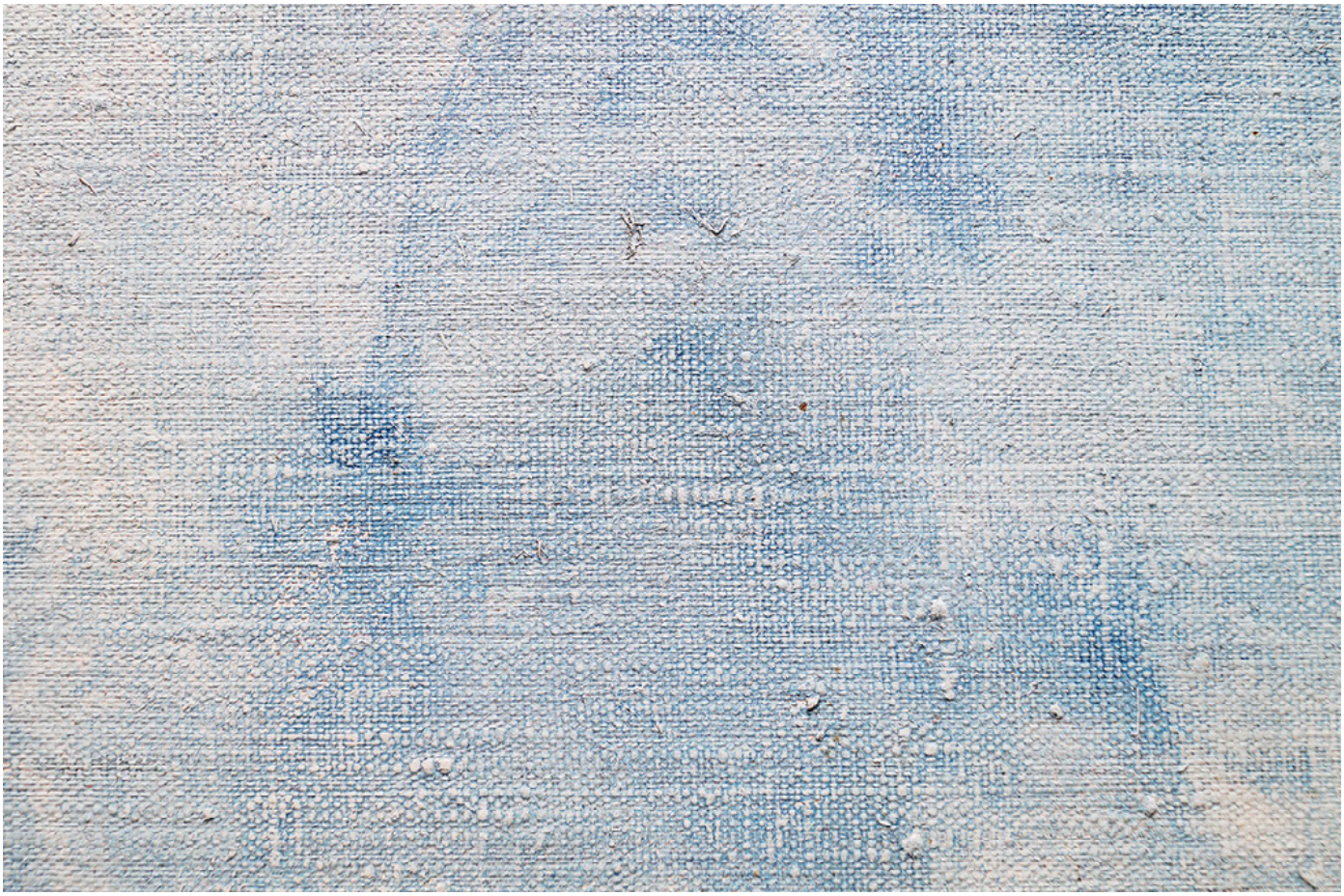
Size: 14x11inches

Year: 2024

Theme: A wandering Ascetic (Series of Painting)

Artist Statement:

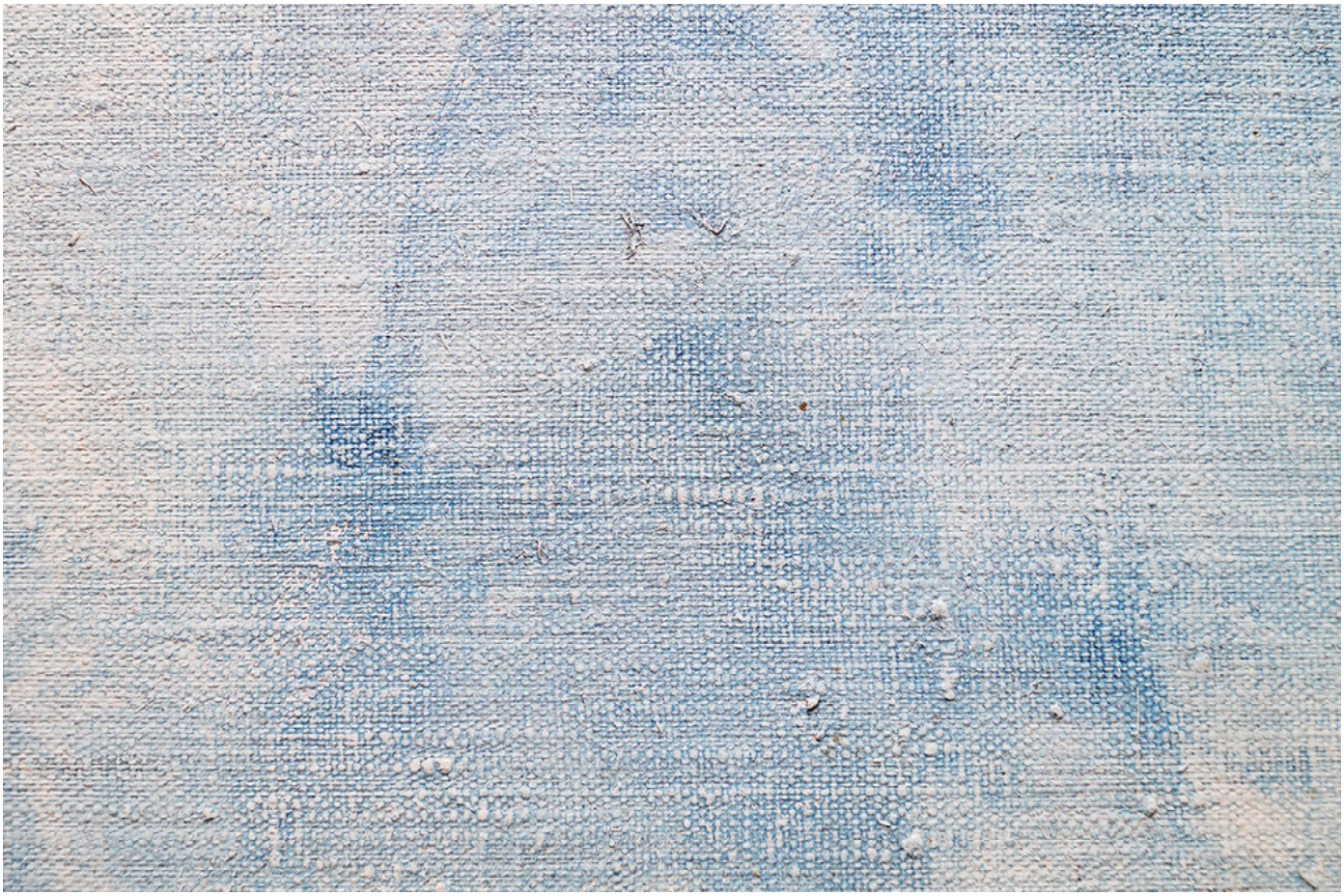
Into the realms of the unknown, while unravelling the sublime intricacies of divine existence. The journey takes us into uncharted territories, delving deep into the mysteries of existence. We embark on a quest to unravel the complexities of divinity, seeking to understand the sublime intricacies that lie beyond our comprehension. In the ethereal realm of creativity, she embarks on an enchanting journey, delving into the mystical depths of the unknown. With her artistic endeavors, she strives to unravel the sublime intricacies that lie within the very fabric of divine existence. With each step, we gain a deeper understanding of our place in the universe and the profound interconnectedness that exist among all beings. This series of paintings draws from the rich cultural heritage of Gandhara, Pakistan, reflecting the spiritual and artistic legacy rooted in tradition. The work explores the themes of impermanence, transformation, and inner awakening.





Title: INFINITY

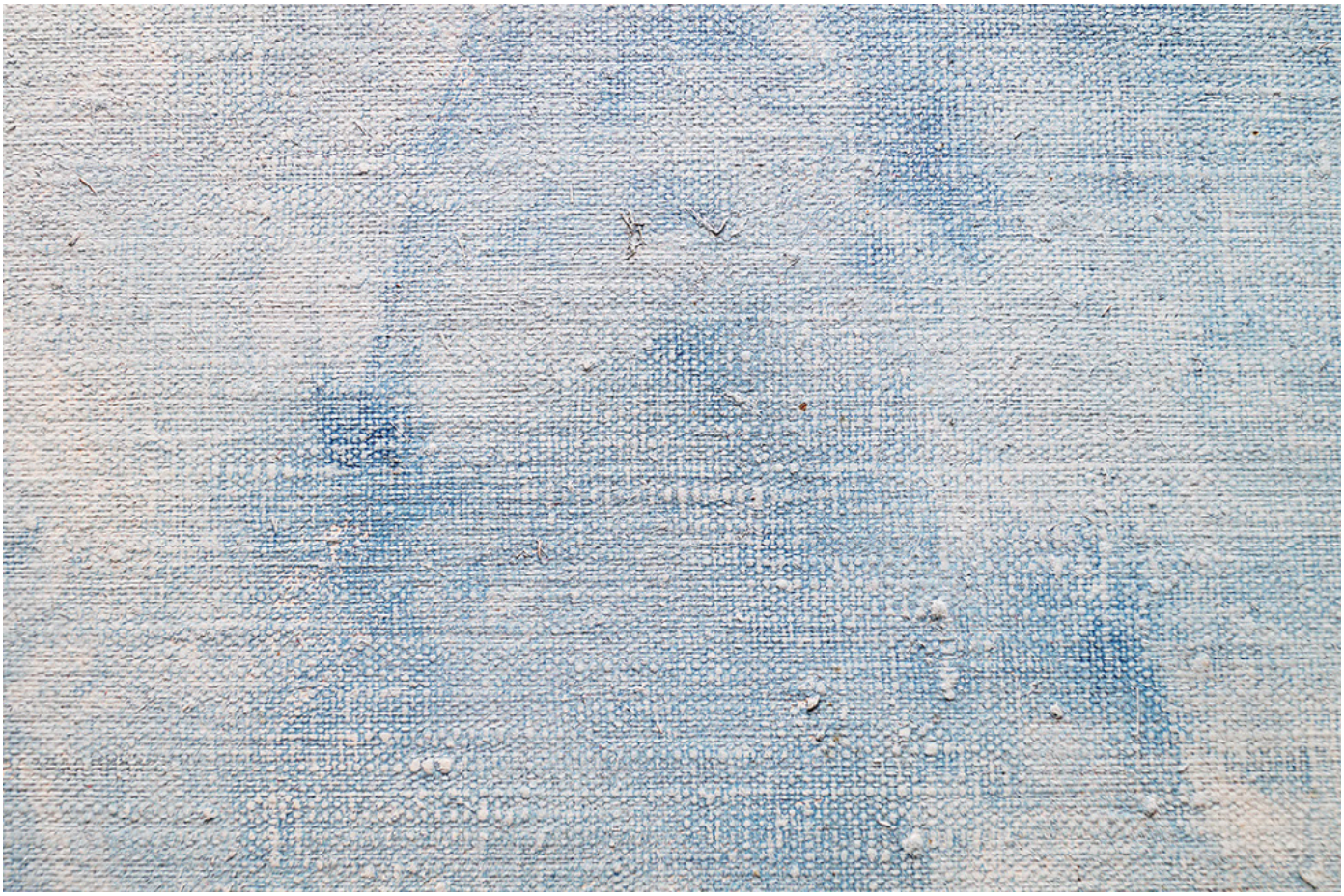
Medium: Gouache on wasli
(prepared with coffee and safeedah (handmade mineral powder) washes, hand-made paper and
hand-made gouache color”
Size: 14×11 inches
Year: 2024





Title: Ethereal Reflection

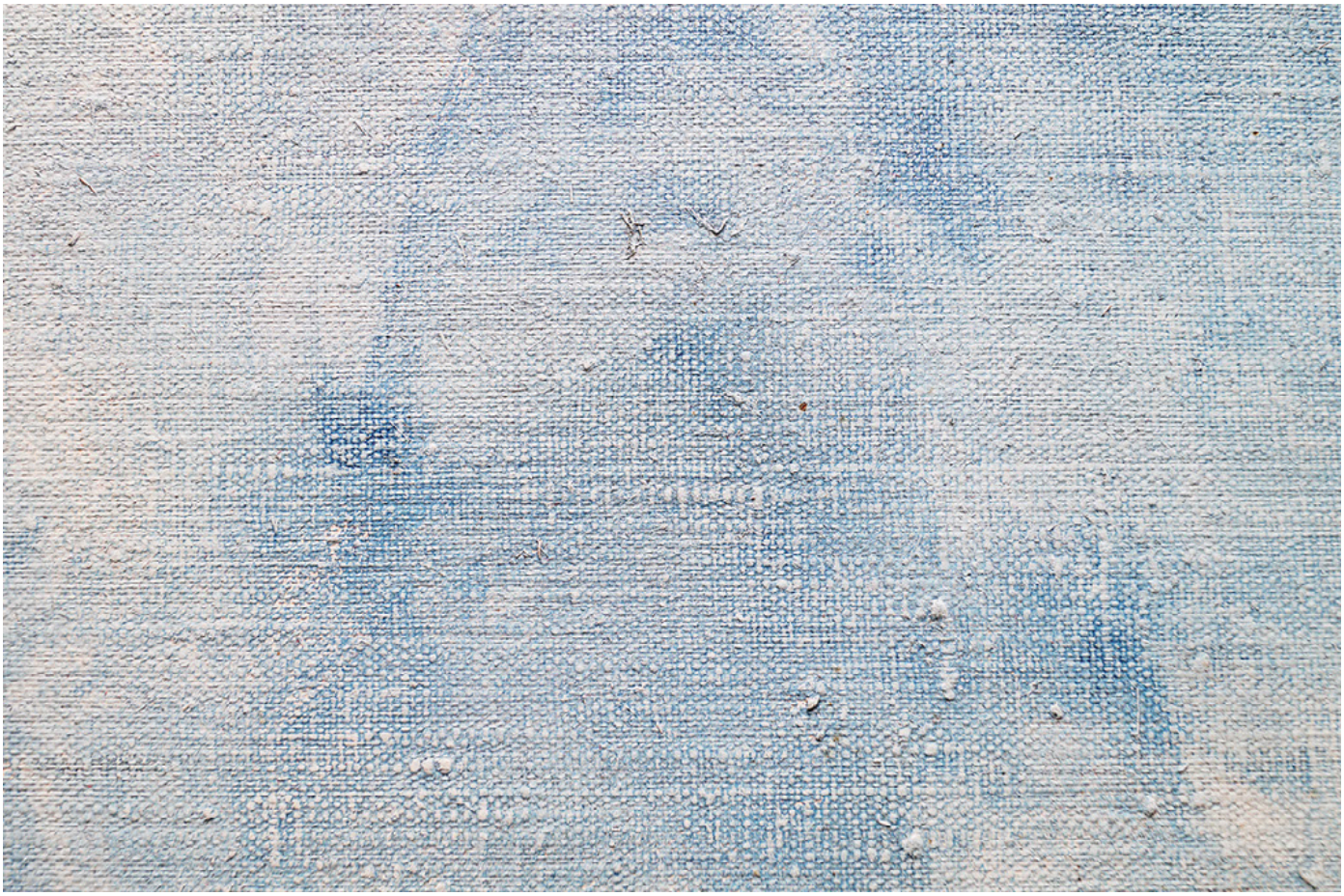
Medium: Gouache on wasli (Hand-made paper and hand-made gouache color)
Size: 14x11inches
Year: 2024





Title: CONVERGENCE OF INFINITE

Medium: Gouache on wasli (Hand-made paper and hand-made gouache color)
Size: 18.5 × 7.7 inches
Year: 2024





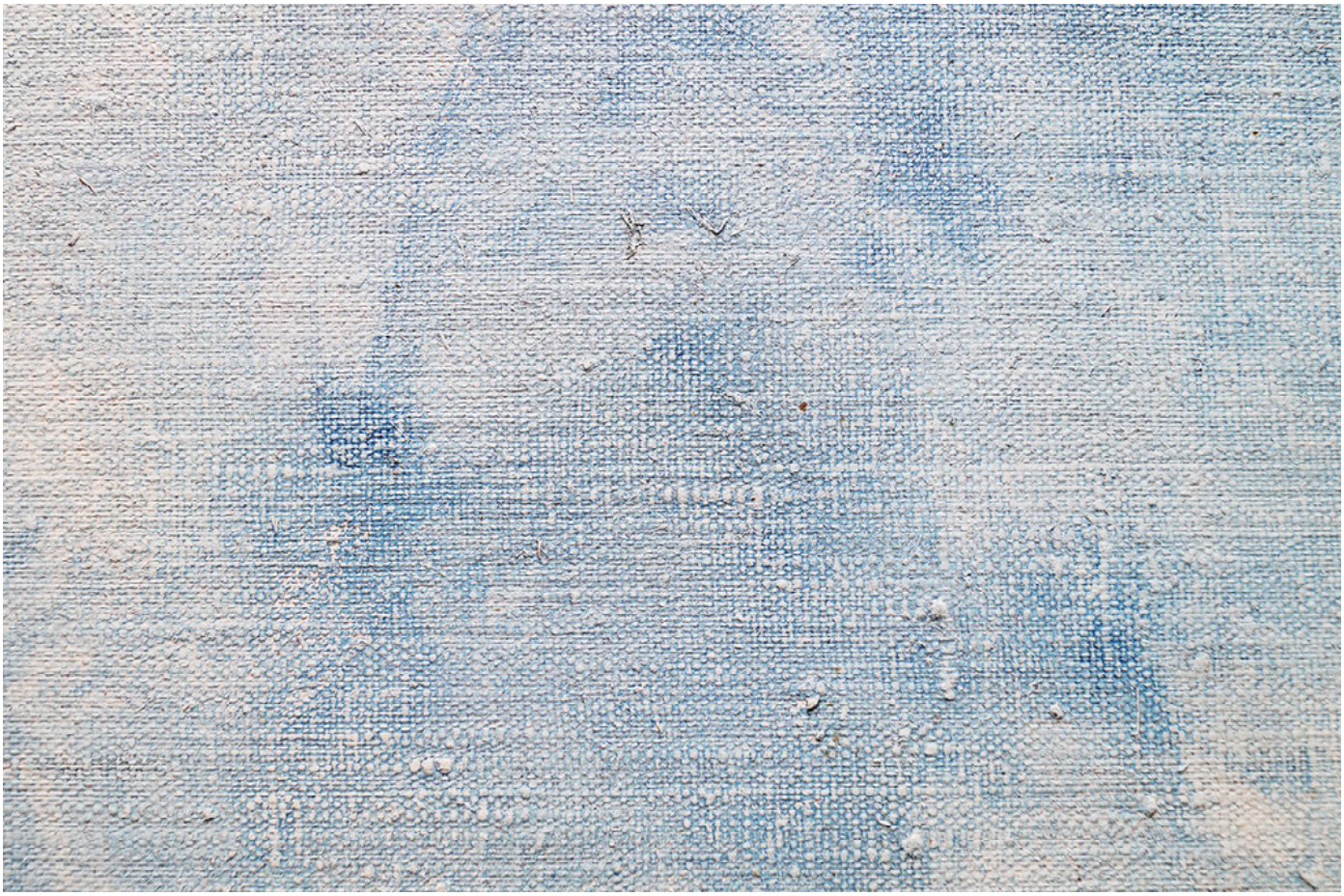
Title: TRANSCENDENCE

Medium: Gouache on wasli
(Hand-made paper and
hand-made gouache color, tea washes)
Size: 14×11 inches
Year: 2024

Theme: Divine Serenity (the series of paintings)

Artist Statement:

Between nature and the feminine, portraying the earth as reflection of hidden faces of femininity. Through its cycles of growth, transformation, and resilience, nature mirrors the Strength, wisdom, mystery and creative power of the feminine spirit. The body of work was created during 2023 in quite beauty of nature of Chatter, Islamabad, Pakistan, where nature beauty and curves of trees inspired me to create this series, explores DIVINE SERENITY, by focusing on the hidden, feminine faces of nature, I challenge traditional portrayals of femininity, offering a more inclusive and holistic view. In exploring the natural world as a reflection of the feminine spirit, I invite others to witness the beauty and strength that lie within the earth and ourselves. Through this connection, urging others to recognize and honor the infinite, ever-evolving nature of the feminine spirit.





Title: ISHQ-E-LAL GEHRA RUNG (Passionate love deepens into crimson)

Creation Unveiled: Feminine infinity in the birth of new earth

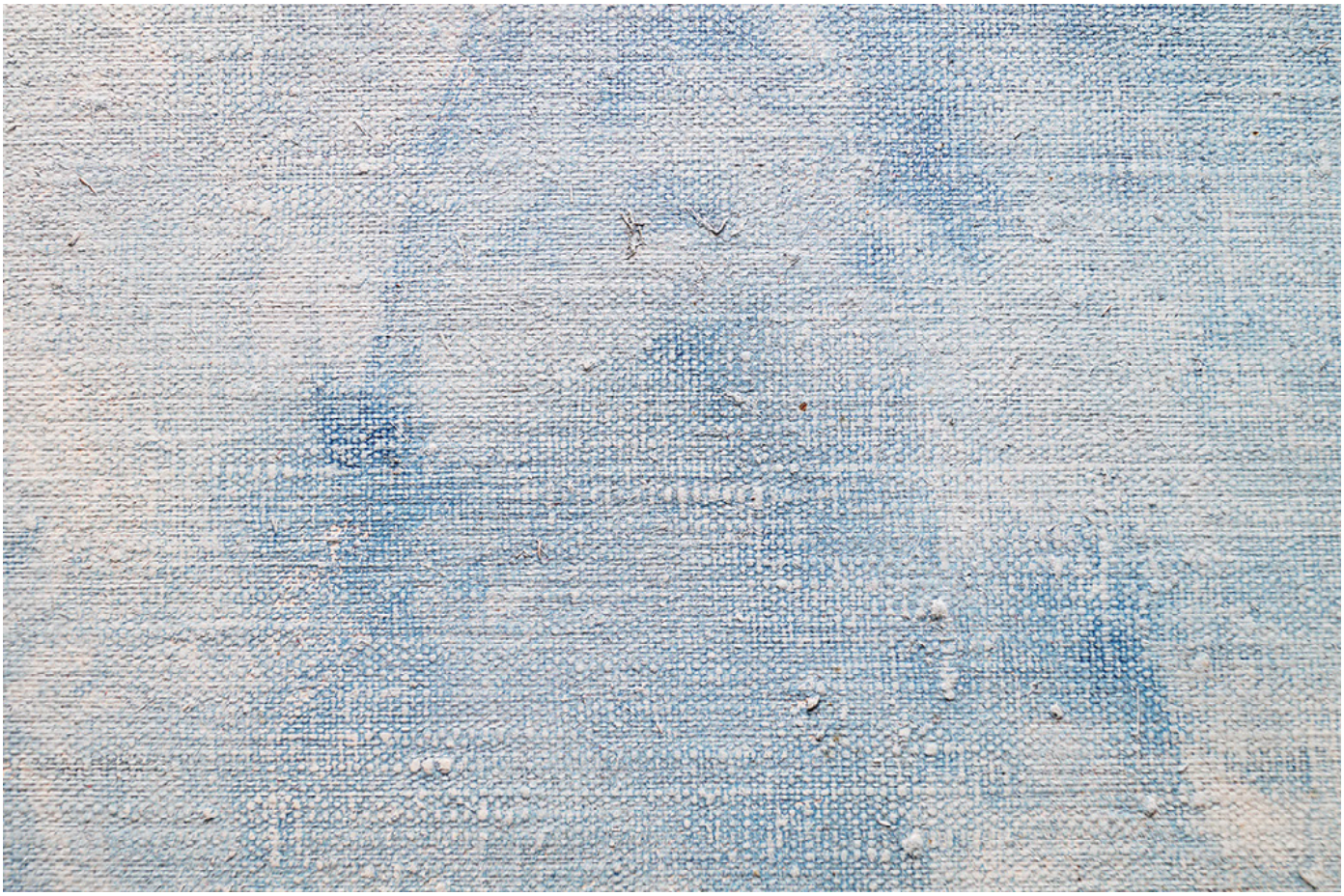
Medium: Gouache on wasli

(Hand-made paper, hand-made color,

tea and gouache washes)

Size: 14x11 inches

Year: 2023





Title: LA-MUHA'DAD TASVEER-E-ILLAHI (the infinite face of the Divine)

“La-muha'dad: she without bounds”

“Tasveer-e-Ellahi: Her infinite form”

Creation Unveiled" Feminine infinity in the birth of new Earth

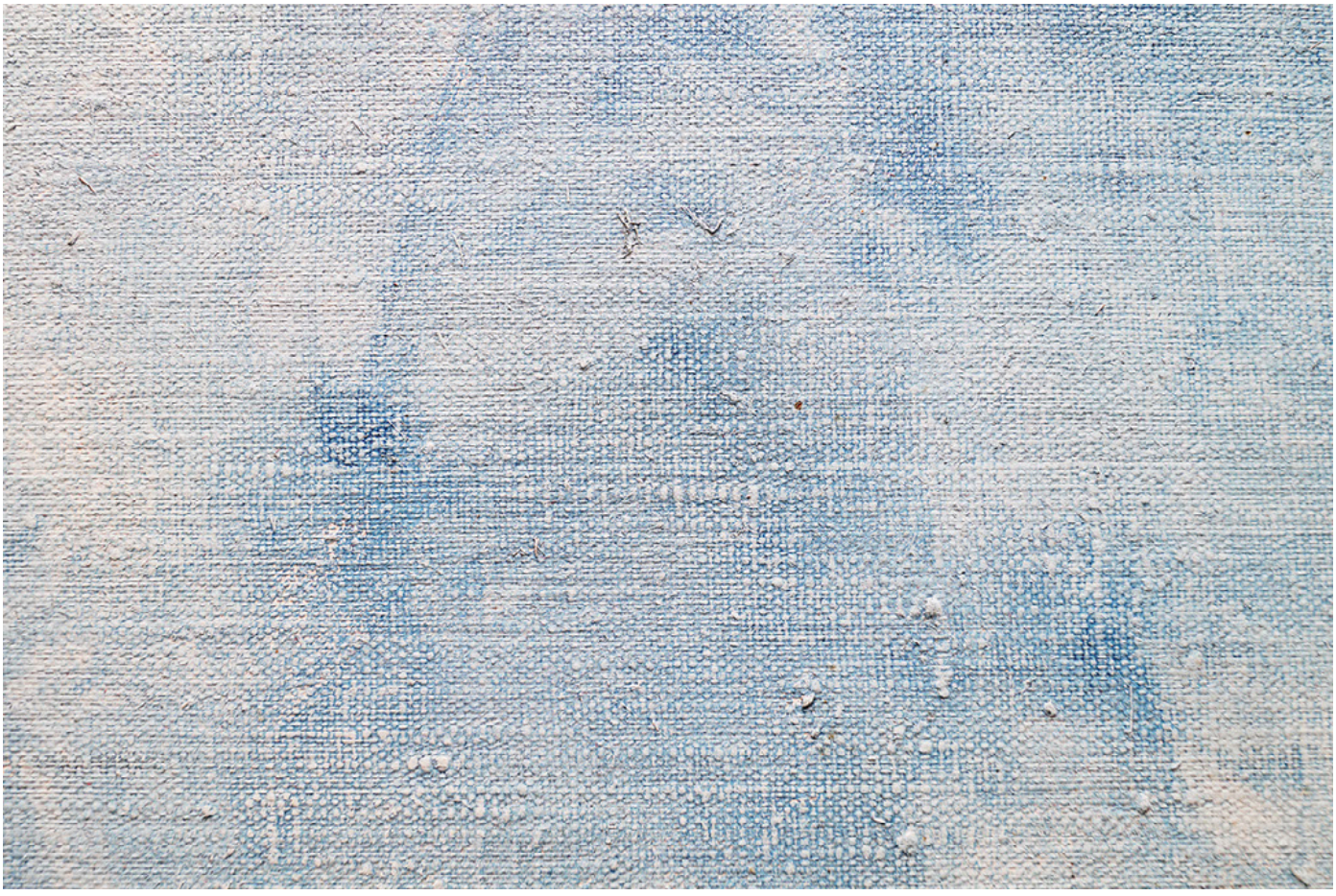
Medium: Gouache on wasli

hand-made paper, handmade gouache color,

prep with tea washes.

Size: 14x11 inches

Year: 2023





Title : ETHEREAL DESTINATION”

Creation unveiled: feminine infinity in the birth of new earth”

Medium: Gouache on wasli,

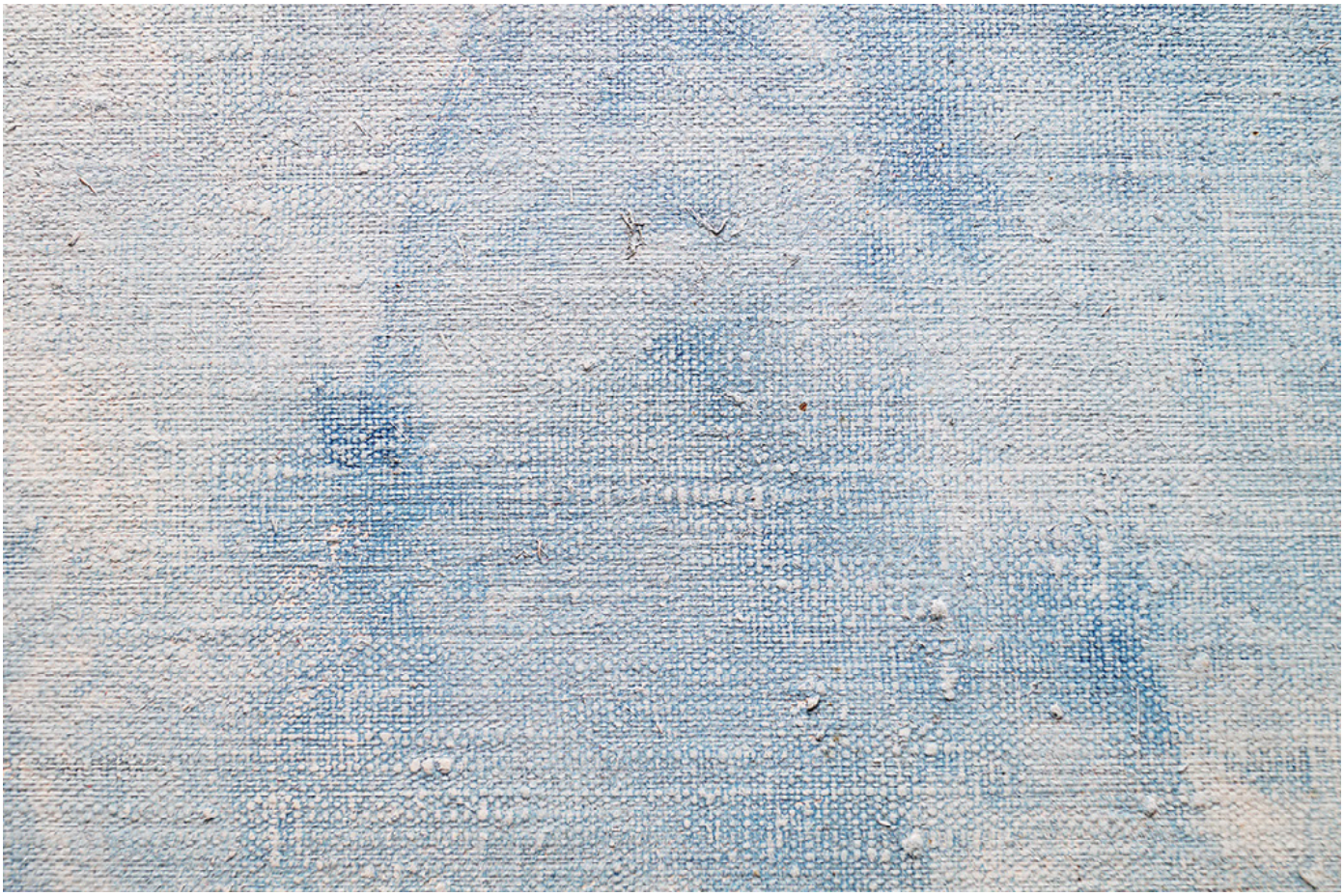
(Handmade paper, handmade gouache color)

Size: 11x14 inches

Year: 2023

Theme: Divine Serenity

Description: nature interaction with the soul, reflecting one’s inner self, incorporate element of Sufiism, using pigeons symbolically and mesmerizing curves of trees inspire me to unfold of the unchartered concepts of femininity and Sufiism further





Title: SERENITY WITH IN (MEDITATION)

Creation unveiled: feminine infinity in the birth of new earth”

Medium: Gouache on Wasli,

(Handmade paper, handmade gouache color)

Size: 14”X11”

Year: 2023

Theme: Divine Serenity’

nature interaction with the soul, reflecting one’s inner self, incorporate element of Sufism, using pigeons symbolically and mesmerizing curves of trees inspire me to unfold of the unchartered concepts of femininity and sufism further.

TRADITIONAL MUGHAL MINIATURE ART WORK

Artist Statement:

This body of work explores femininity as a sacred and transformative force, expressed through the presence of the divine feminine. The figures embody a deity like essence, merging strength, grace, and spiritual depth beyond physical form. Through these expressions, I seek to honor femininity as both creator and cosmic energy, inviting on its timeless power.





TITLE “EXPRESSION OF DEITY”

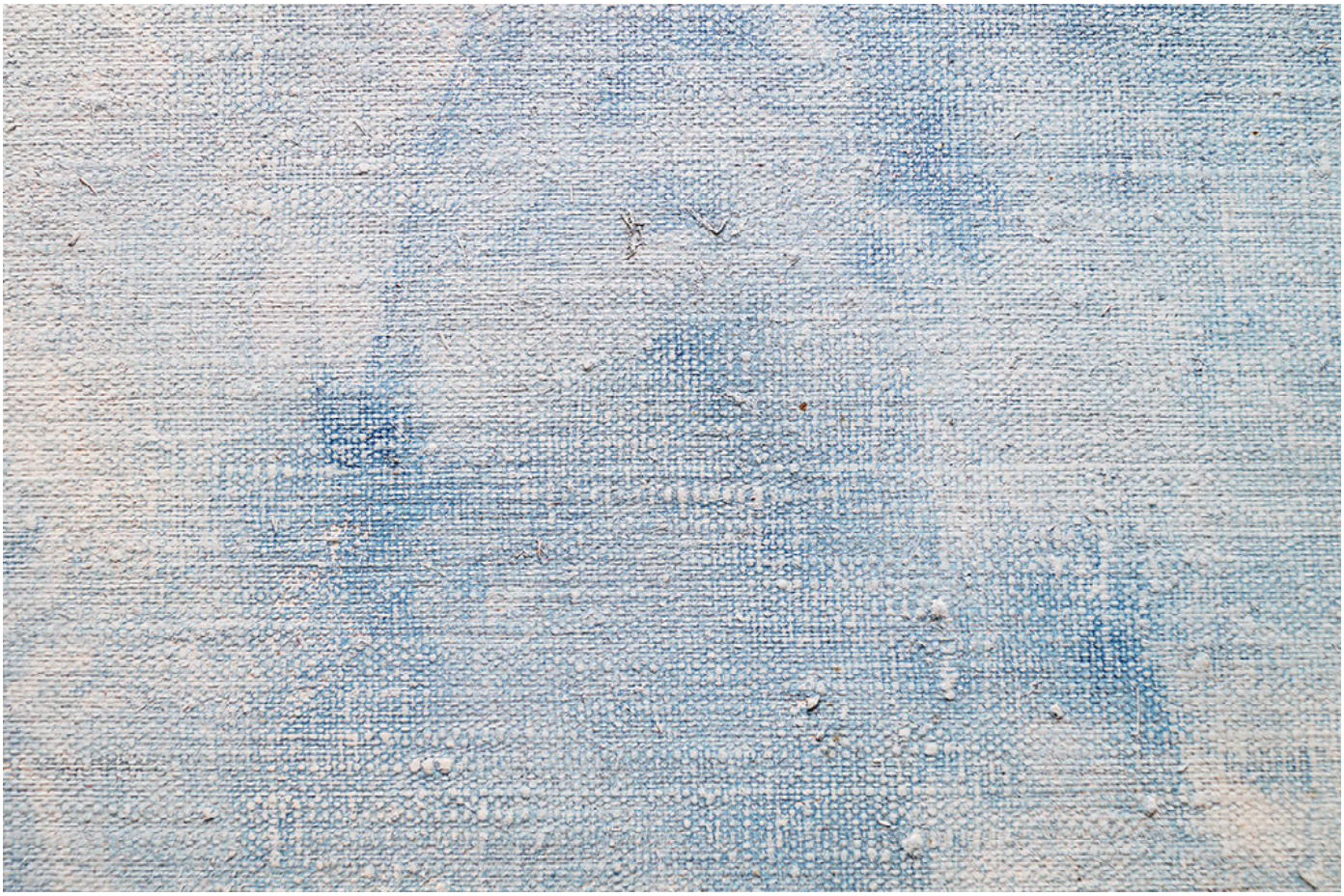
Medium: Gouache on Wasli

Handmade paper, handmade gouache color, coffee wash, silver and gold leaf spray

Calligraphy: Punjabi Sufi poetry Verses.

Size: 48x42cm

Year: 2016





Title: THE VISIBLE SELF AND THE UNSEEN WITHIN

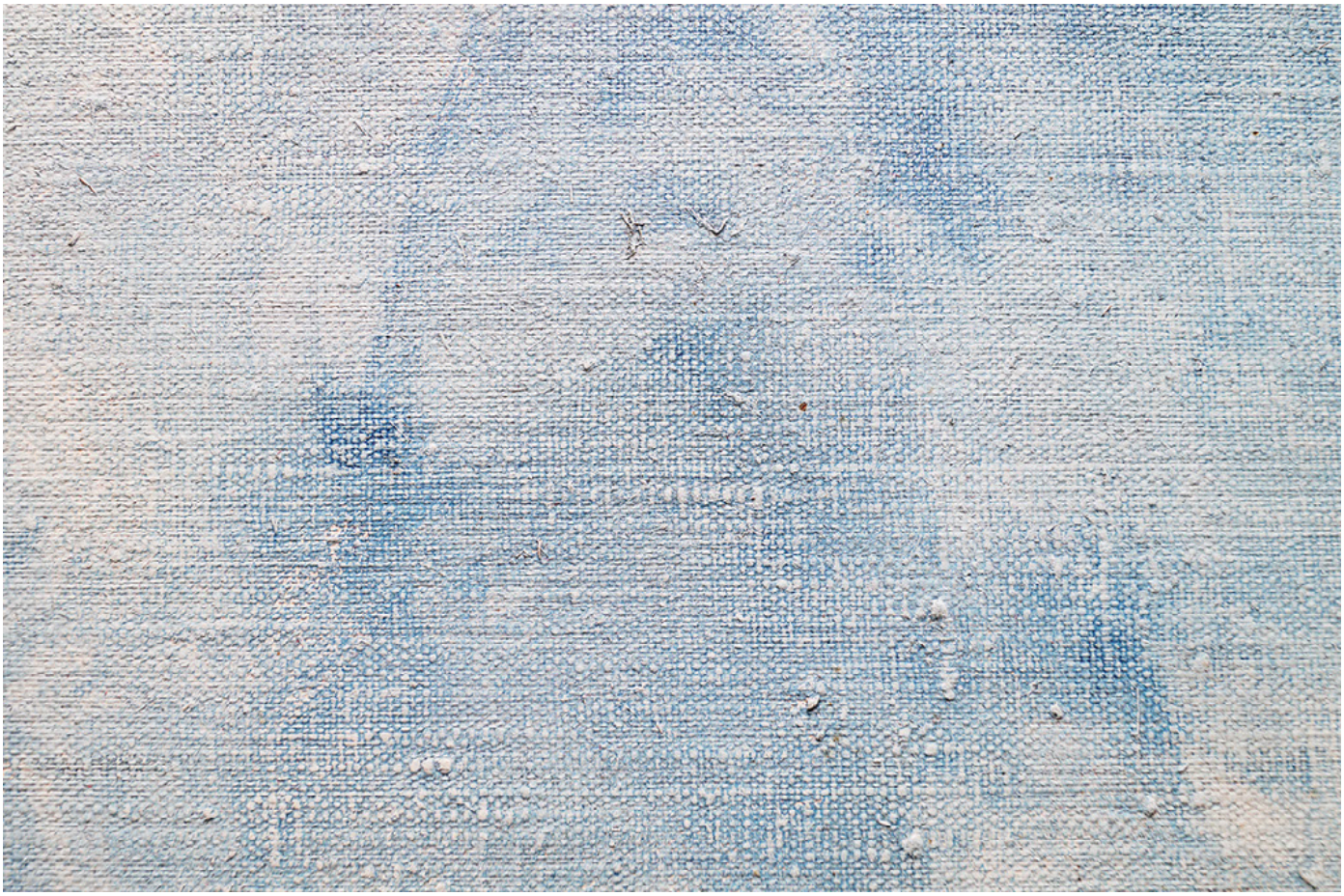
Medium: Traditional Mughal miniature marbling,
new-paper print portrait on wasli,
(Handmade paper, prep with tea wash)
Size: 32x25cm
Year: 2016
Artist Statement:
Exploring identity through what is revealed and what remains hidden, it connects the partial portrait with the idea that femineity is more than what is physical visible.
This work examens identity through fragmentation and restraint. The half face reveals only a part of subject, leaving the unseen to become part of the narrative. The frame suggests boundaries between visibility and concealment, presence and absence. Together they invite reflection on how identity is perceived, constructed and experienced.

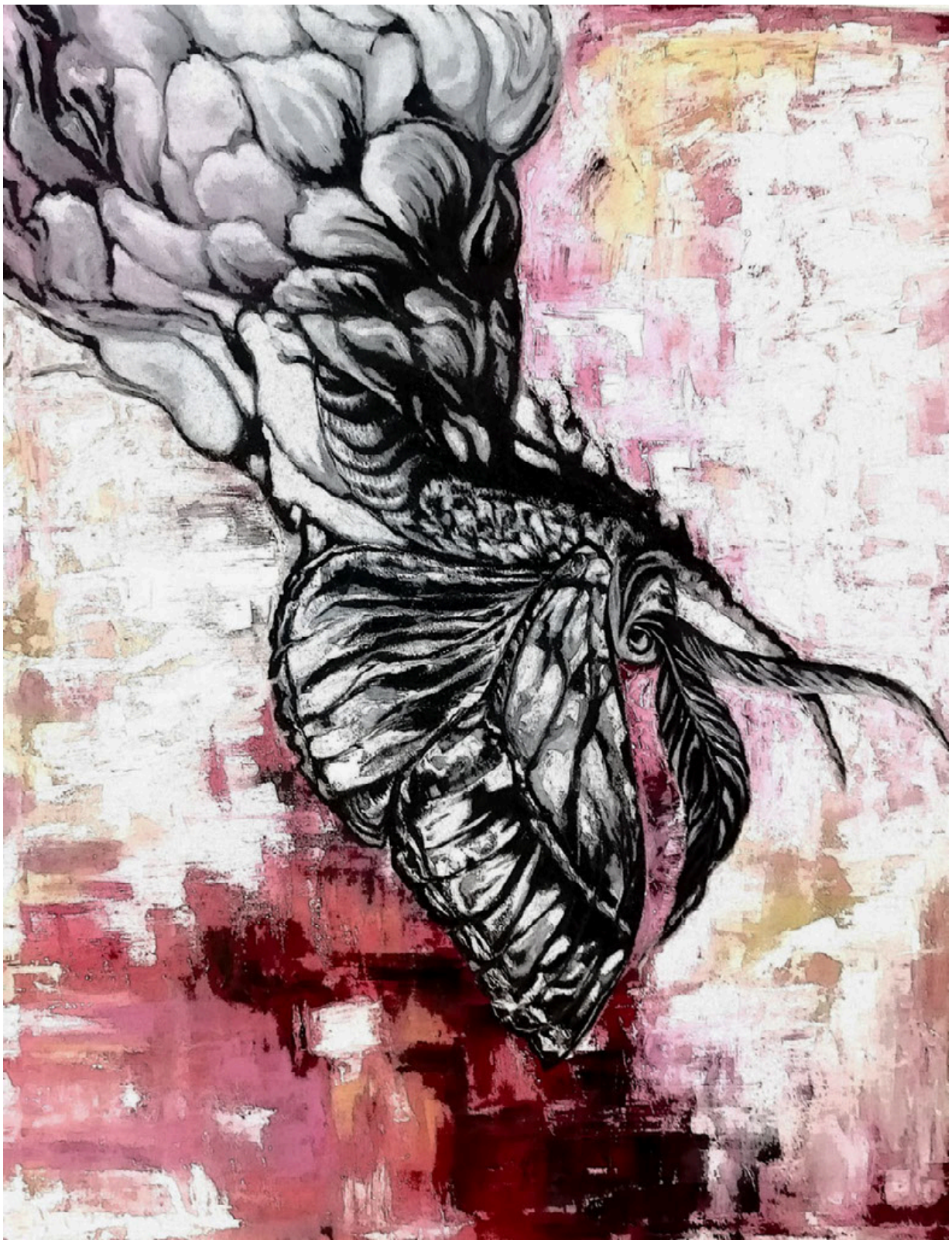
Theme: The Beauty We Overlook

Artist Statement:

This work explores femininity through the symbolism of the butterfly, representing the black-and-white palette of butterfly challenges the conventional association of femininity with color and ornamentation, instead revealing its quieter complexities through contrast. In this painting, the language of colors, red symbolizes passion, intensity and emotional depth of existence and metaphorically black and white butterfly becomes a metaphor for the feminine qualities that can exist beneath the surface—strength within delicacy, resilience within vulnerability, and individuality within social expectations. Like the beauty of a garden that becomes visible only when we pause to observe it, femininity can also be overlooked when we see only its outward appearance.

Through its simplicity and contrast, the painting invites the viewer to slow down and look beyond the obvious—to recognize the beauty, complexity, and strength that already surround us. Through this visual language the work narrates journey of life, change and the evolving nature of the soul.





Title: A Call of Infinite Beauty

Medium: Oil paints on Canvas

Size: 29.8 x 24 inches

Year: 2017

Credits:

Created with images by • fotokup - Detail of old canvas • Mr Twister - abstract hand painted grunge canvas background

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